



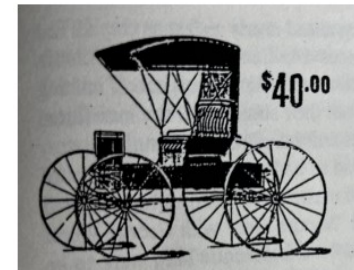
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CHAPTER VIII ADOBE HOME 1853

“It has been twelve months this day since I first came down to this place with eleven wagons for to commence a settlement. It was then a wild desert, but is now a fruitful field. The work that has been accomplished at this place for the last year is a miracle – by a small number of men, not many more than thirty. We now number about sixty. Commemorated the day by having a ‘ball’ in the evening and some splendid speeches were given on this occasion. Good order prevailed and we enjoyed ourselves very much.” The preceding entry was written in Henry Lunt’s journal on November 11, 1852.

A few days before, on November 8, a group of settlers left Cedar city and headed south to search for a good location for cattle ranches. The party consisted of George A. Smith, Elisha H. Groves, John D. Lee, William Leaney, Tarlton Lewis and several others. They returned the following day at which time George A. Smith counseled John D. Lee and a few others to erect a fort on a creek (Ash Creek) some 22 miles southwest of Cedar City. The new settlement was to be called Harmony. Smith also suggested that about ten families settle and build a fort on the creek 12 miles south of Cedar which would be called Kanarra. In addition, he felt that two more families should join Shirts and Hamilton on Shirts’s Creek and “fort up” in a compact manner.¹

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The Iron Works was not going ahead nearly as fast as they all had hoped and on Sunday, November 14, George A. Smith called a council of the brethren after church meeting for the purpose of inviting them to express their feelings about their situation. They manifested a great disunion among themselves and thought they had suffered very much. Some of them had even had to go barefoot and were short of clothing. The next morning Smith mustered all the men together and organized a company of mounted "Minute Men" with George Wood as Captain and Sixtus Johnson as 1st Lieutenant. They were to be ready at a minutes notice with horse and rider to alert everyone of any ensuing danger, Indians or otherwise.

Some of the men were anxious to move ahead on the manufacture of iron. The chemist, James James, had been experimenting and brought a sample of iron which he made to show Henry. James talked about commencing a new iron company and said he believed he could make iron in a puddling furnace and with the help of a few more men could make considerable iron this winter. Henry agreed to lay the matter before George A. Smith. The next morning he and James and John Griffiths traveled to Parowan to discuss starting a new company, and Smith said that he would be very glad if James could form a small company and make iron. That afternoon Henry and the other two men went exploring and found more iron in Little Creek Canyon. Henry wrote: "Brother James and John Steele built a small air furnace in my old house in Parowan for to make a trial of the ore that we found. The trail was made and, about 12 midnight, the ore melted and some little iron came out. The furnace was rather too small or we would have done better." When Henry returned from Parowan he brought back 258 feet of lumber to cover his new house.

Franklin D. Richards and Erastus Snow came from Salt Lake City reaching Parowan on Saturday, November 20. Henry recorded: "I was introduced to them and rejoiced in their society. They brought mail." The following Wednesday Richards and Snow traveled to Cedar Fort and stayed for several days. They visited the Iron Works and counseled Henry in setting up the accounts for the company, and their visit instilled new enthusiasm in the iron workers and dispelled the plans for operating a separate furnace.

Henry was able to get two pairs of boots and a few other items from the merchandise that Richards and Snow had brought with them for the Cedar City saints. These goods added to the comfort of the needy brethren and sisters. On Wednesday, December 1, Henry was appointed as a member of the committee to adopt prices for wages for labor and prices for commodities. He wrote the following entry in his journal:

We met in the blacksmith shop at the Iron Works at about twelve. John C. L. Smith was appointed chairman and Henry Lunt, Secretary. The following prices were agreed upon as a medium, not regarding them in all cases as unalterable: common labor--\$1.50 per day; carpenters--\$2 to \$2.50; millwrights and masons--\$2 to \$2.50; setting adobes--25 cents per 100 and tenders--one-third less. Blacksmiths--\$2.50 per day; molders--\$2.50; furnace keepers--\$3.50; feeder--\$2.50; assistant keeper--\$2.50. For a team and wagon--\$1.25; adobes--\$.50 per hundred; wheat--\$1.25 per bushel; oats--\$.75 per bushel; potatoes--\$.75 per bushel; turnips--\$.40 per bushel; shelled corn--\$1.25 per bushel; and beets, carrots, and parsnips--\$.75 per bushel. Beef (alive)--6 cents per pound; 6 to 8 centers per quarter; killed cows--\$25 per head; oxen--\$60 to \$80 per yoke; and lumber--\$2.50 per hundred.

Sat in counsel and writing until 4 o'clock in the morning.

The following comment appeared in an article written by Henry Lunt in the *Deseret News* on December 2, 1852: "There has been a thorough organization for the manufacture of iron under the firm of the Deseret Iron Company. A large sum has already been subscribed and extensive contracts made, and the manufacture of iron goods is certain and all that is wanted is Mormon capital, 'bone and sinew.' All is peace and prosperity and never, as yet, been afflicted with

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sickness. Our little number has been increased this season by some fifteen families."

Franklin Richards and Erastus Snow left for Great Salt Lake City the morning of Thursday, December 2, 1852. Lunt wrote: "They have done much good while in our midst, and may God bless them forever. John D. Lee came in the evening with Mary Groves who had been sealed to him by Brother Snow. Brother Lee gave me about a bushel of beets that were raised from the seed that came from France."

Representing the Stake Presidency of the Cedar City saints, Henry set up the schedule for Sunday meetings to be at 10 a.m. and 2 p.m. The bell was to be rung ten minutes before each meeting to inform the settlers that the meetings would begin. On Sunday, December 5, Henry wrote: "It was ½ past 11 a.m. before meeting commenced on account of the Bishop not ringing the bell sooner." President Lunt assigned James Whittaker to be responsible for ringing the bell in the future.³

In his message to the Territorial Legislature on December 13, 1852, Governor Brigham Young gave the following information on the economic situation of the people in Utah:

Domestic manufacturers, I am happy to state are in a flourishing condition; considerable quantities of leather and crockery have found their way into market, and a large amount of clothing has been made, principally by the hand of the good housewife who thereby adds dignity to her station and reflects credit and honor upon her household. Specimens of iron have also been forwarded from the works in Iron County which, for the first run, was exceedingly flattering. It separates well but, owing to the sulphur in the coal not being sufficiently extracted, was thereby injured. But, a little experience in combining materials and continued effort, it is believed, will soon produce that article in great abundance and of good quality. A liberal hand should be extended unto the

enterprising men who have nobly devoted their time, under circumstances of penury and want, in producing an article of so much moment as iron to the urgent necessities and future wealth of the Territory. It will soon pay its own way and become a source of profit to the producers but, until returns can be received, the enterprise exhausts the means of operators and they should be relieved by the public funds. I am also happy to announce the arrival in our Territory of the machinery for the manufacture of sugar from the beet. The machinery and operators who have been accustomed to the manufacture of that article from the beet have come together from the 'old world' and, being under the direction of energetic, enterprising, and able men, will doubtless soon furnish an abundant supply of that article for the wants of the people.

Richards and Snow succeeded in making the Cedar City saints realize that the manufacture of iron was an important process for the entire state. Henry felt a very heavy responsibility resting upon his shoulders in regards to the Iron Works. The Mormons were, in a very literal sense, isolated from the world. They must not only supply themselves with sufficient food, but they must produce their own building materials, manufacture their own clothing, provide their own educational system, construct their own roads, and devise their own system of communication. This isolation forced them to exercise great initiative. It was seen from the outset that iron would be needed for ploughshares, wire, scythes, cradles, household utensils such as stoves and skillets, horse and oxen shoes, nails, and wagon tires. Brigham Young emphasized the need of an iron foundry in his first epistle issued to the saints in 1849.⁴

Necessity developed a leadership and force of character which permeated the most humble household. Fortunately for the saints, the membership of the Church was drawn from the great middle-class of society, trained and inured to labor. It contained artisans from every walk of life. The first generation of pioneers who settled in the valleys

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of the mountains were blessed with an array of trained laborers. This was a vital factor in the success of the Mormons as colonizers.⁵ Experienced workers had been sent to southern Utah to help in the manufacture of iron, but they were encountering more difficulties than they had expected.

Cedar City received several snow storms in December and on Thursday, December 23, 1852, Henry wrote:

Tremendous stormy night of wind, rain, and snow from the south. Snow on the ground, about four inches. Brother John Hamilton and George Shirts came with a carriage and a pair of horses for Ellen and I and a few others for to go to a party at Brother Hamilton's [at the Shirt's settlement about five miles south of Cedar City]. We arrived there about 5 o'clock p.m. It was very cold and the mountains looked most beautiful and sublime all white over with snow. Enjoyed a most excellent supper and afterwards enjoyed ourselves in dancing and talking and speaking on principle. Brother and Sister Shirts were with us at the party. Snowed and stormed all night with a very strong south wind. The next morning, December 24, the snow was drifted as high as two feet. I was told that the snow at Brother Lee's settlement, some 20 miles south of Coal Creek, was two feet deep on the ground. Brothers George Shirts and John Hamilton brought us back to Cedar Fort in the carriage. Arrived home about eleven o'clock and went up to the Iron Works. Attended the dinner party in the school house at 3 o'clock p.m. A very excellent dinner was provided and about 60 feasted thereof. The guests assembled again at ½ past five p.m. and, after singing and prayer, dancing commenced and, together with songs, glees, and pieces which were performed, the amusements were continued until about 12 midnight. The choir then went about the

Fort singing Christmas songs which serenaded the town most beautifully. Then they returned to the schoolhouse and partook of some refreshments, received some instructions, and danced again until daylight. The house was most beautifully decorated with evergreens interspersed with artificial flowers and a number of pictures hung around the room.

On Christmas day the entire town met at 1 p.m. for a meeting. Henry and Ellen dined with the Walkers and a small party after the meeting and had an excellent dinner of roast beef and plum pudding. Everyone met again at 6 p.m. and continued with dancing and amusements until late at night. They gathered donations of food to give to the Indians. So ended the second Christmas in the settlement of Cedar City.

On Sunday, December 26, Henry delivered a lecture on the duties of children and parents in regards to getting an education and speaking good English.⁶ He was probably one of the best educated men in the community, having received his schooling in England under a strict school system. (This was probably the reason he was usually chosen to be secretary and keep journals for the church and Iron Works). Many of the settlers could not read, much less do any writing. On Thursday, December 30, Henry wrote in his journal:

Very fine warm day, no frost and remarkably muddy. Made another trial of the iron ore in the cupola [a re-heating furnace] at the Iron Works. After a good trial for about 15 hours, there was no iron and it is the judgment of all that there is something in it that eats the iron away. I attended prayer meeting in the evening and read a proclamation which Brigham had published in the *Deseret News* last year respecting the first day of the new year. It should be kept as a day of praise and thanksgiving unto the Lord. I also invited them to give liberally of their abundance to the poor so that they might rejoice with us and we would

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all rejoice together and be glad. I promised them a dance which was to commence at 3 o'clock on that afternoon. Brother George Wood expressed a desire to be rebaptized and wished for me to baptize him tomorrow at noon. Nephi Johnson, John Nelson, and Margret Easton [John Eastons's wife] also requested to be rebaptized.

The baptisms took place the next day in the icy waters of Coal Creek. Henry gave a good large piece of beef to the Bishop for the poor and a piece of beef and a load of hay to David Cook.

Henry and Ellen celebrated New Year's day by inviting a group of people for dinner. Those who came were Brother and Sister Shirts, Brother Lee, Father and Mother Whittaker and their family consisting of James, age 19, Mary, age 14, and Sarah, age 12. The entire community met in the afternoon and sang hymns and enjoyed an entertaining program. Many poems were recited and throughout the peaceful colony the whole of the day was spent in rejoicing and giving thanks.

On Sunday, January 2, after Sacrament Meeting, a Utah Indian prevailed upon Henry to go to his wickiup and administer to one of the Indians who hurt his knee when he fell over some rocks while hunting. After this was accomplished, Henry chatted with a very intelligent Indian named Arapine who had been with Chief Walker. He could speak considerable English and said that Walker was trading with the Moquitch Indians and would be along by and by and would bring "a heap of horses."

Sunday was the day to conduct, not only spiritual meetings, but Bishop's Court when needed which concerned disciplinary action for church members. Henry wrote about one such meeting held that day:

Attended a Bishop's Court in the evening held at Brother Wiley's house. The case was as follows: Brother Wiley preferred a charge against his wife and Adam Nicholson for their unchristian like conduct. It appeared that Brother Wiley had seen them kiss each

other and, after telling Nicholson to not come in his house any more, he took no notice, but came in and out just as he pleased. They both denied the charge and, after some examination, were found guilty and cut off from the church. The Bishop reproved them severely.

Henry discussed the Iron Works with Brothers Bladen and Adams the following day and felt that the spirit they manifested was better than it had been before. On January 4, Brother Parks laid the floor in Henry and Ellen's house. Henry spent the day with Brother James analyzing the iron ore. A meeting was held in the evening concerning the removal of the "big field." Henry wrote:

After considerable litigation and a great deal said, some for and some against removing it, they all voted to move the field on the south side of the creek and there to make a very small compact field with a good fence around so that the cattle could not possibly break through. By removing the old field we could release all the brethren engaged in the Iron Works.

Saturday, January 5: My heifer, 'Nut', had a calf. Brother Stones came early to me this morning and informed me that the Indians had stolen his pony out of his pen. Almost at the same time Bishop Smith told me his pony was also gone and that one of the Indians had told him that an Indian from the Utah Camp had stolen them, and they thought he was gone to Sanpete. I sent up to the Iron Works for Brother George Wood, Captain of the 'Minute Company.' He came down and I instructed him to go with a company of some six or eight men in search of the Indian thieves. They started on horseback and returned about noon with the Bishop's pony which they found some two miles northeast of the city in the Cedars, but they could not discover any Indians nor the other pony. I

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instructed Brother Nephi Johnson, Indian interpreter, and Brother Wood to go to the Utah's camp and tell them that if they would get the pony back again and bring the boy that stole it, we would pay them for their trouble. And, if they would not do that, if we found that boy we should shoot him. However, if they would fetch him, we would not kill him, but whip him.

Spent most of the afternoon at the Iron Works. Commenced building the foundation of an air furnace, or rather the stack for an air furnace which will also answer for four furnaces.

Henry preached to the congregation on the following Sunday about the mission that they were sent here to perform, namely to manufacture iron. He urged and exhorted the settlers to "attend to that thing and to let farming alone entirely." Henry wrote the following entries in his journal:

January 11, 1853: I was aroused out of my bed this morning by the report of two guns soon after which four Pihede Indians came into the house and told us that the Utah Indians had shot into their camp. Soon after, some of the Pihede wickiups were all on fire. It appeared afterwards from the testimony of one of the Pihedes that the Utahs had bought one of the Pihede squaws and the squaw had run away and that made the Utahs mad. I went to the Utah's camp and had a conversation with 'Tab' and 'Chrosefene,' the two chiefs, and they appeared very friendly with me. They asked me if I would invite my people to give them some flour, as they were going to leave this point at noon today. I told them I would and I sent around the Fort and collected some 75 pounds of flour to give them. I told them to see that none of their men drove off any of our cattle or horses. The Utah Tribe left at 12 o'clock. They said they were going to Sanpete.

Myself and wife and Father and Mother Whittaker attended a supper party at Brother Chatterly's. President J. C. L. Smith came in from Parowan in the evening.

Wednesday, January 12: Very sharp frost. Spent the day at the Iron Works--had 25 men at work. Father Gould commenced piling up a pit of wood for to burn for charcoal. Myself, J. C. L. Smith, and James James opened a splendid mine of excellent bog ore one mile northeast of the Iron Works.

Henry rode to Parowan with George Wood the following Saturday to visit and counsel with the Stake Presidency. While he was there three men arrived from Salt Lake City and brought a large amount of mail to the settlers, among which were three issues of the *Deseret News* which contained some very interesting news. The residents looked forward to receiving the *News* as it kept them in contact with the other settlements and informed them of the happenings in the entire state. Henry took the orders and distributed the newspaper for southern Utah.⁷ Henry wrote:

The mail contained a quantity of letters. I received a letter from George A. Smith which informed me that he was in good health and spirits but had no wood, no hay, and no money on hand. Also said that the Legislature had appropriated three thousand dollars to be expended in the coal and iron business in Iron County.

I stayed at Brother Barton's house until Monday, January 17. Bought a bedstead from Sister James Lewis for six dollars.

Tuesday, January 18, 1853: Very sharp frost. Cloudy morning--commenced snowing about 8 a.m. and stormed slowly all day.

Saturday, January 22: Brother Parks finished the carpentering work in my house--charged me twenty

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five dollars. Settled with Brother Robert Wiley for building my house, he agreed to strike level [call it even]. He also agreed for me to have the 10 acres of land at Parowan. Snow, about three inches in the evening.

Sunday, January 23: Very excellent meeting, a number of brethren spoke. Ellen bore her testimony. I made a few closing remarks and counseled the brethren for to have their guns and ammunition on hand and to take notice and listen to the tales of the Indians, but not to tell them our intentions. I had heard that the Utah Indians were mad and had said that they would come and kill us some night for we were cowards and durst not fight them. I have learned from the Pihedes that the Utahs killed five of the Pihedes and five more were wounded. They also stole a lot of children and some women. I would here remark that the Utah Tribe never were half so good behaved as the Pihede Tribe, neither are they industrious like the Pihedes. The Pihedes have hither to, as a general thing, been peaceable and kind and are willing to work for bread or anything else to eat. Truly, they do a vast amount of work for this people, and may God bless them and inspire their hearts to do right and to learn the habits of industry and cleanliness.

Wednesday, January 26: Thawing very fast, but little frost. Brother W. H. Dame came for the purpose of surveying a field on the south side of the creek below the city. I called a public meeting in the evening for to ascertain who wanted land and how much. I counseled the brethren to take but very little land, and those who were engaged in the Iron Works to take none. There were names given in for 298 acres--68 one-acre lots and 46 five-acre lots.

President J. C. L. Smith and Henry Lunt selected a piece of land

for the new field and picked out a place to build a bridge over the creek. There were nearly a hundred Pihede Indians camped on the south side of the creek. They were peaceable. Henry wrote:

Saturday, January 29: I baptized Catherine Chatterley in the afternoon seven times for the restoration of her health. I also rebaptized Mary Ann Corlett, Mary Whittaker, and Joseph Chatterley.

Sunday, January 30: Attended meeting in the morning, Bishop Smith preached. An Indian came in town a little before noon and inquired for me. He said that Indian Chief Walker would be here in five sleeps. There were two more Indians with him. I counseled the brethren to have all their guns ready for use and on hand. I also counseled them to put all their loose cattle in the herd.

Henry, James James, and an Indian went exploring and found a small spring of pure salt water about three miles east of the city in a dry canyon leading out of Coal Creek Canyon. They felt that this would be of great benefit to the community. Henry wrote: "Upon my return I heard that George Wood and Richard Benson had been fighting."

Father and James Whittaker put some earth on Henry and Ellen's house on Friday, February 4. They also hauled a load of firewood for them. Henry and Ellen moved out of the Whittaker's house into their new home the next day, February 5. Henry wrote:

I feel very thankful to them and the rest of the family for their many acts of benevolence and charity rendered unto me and my wife. I have not in my power at the present time to pay them for their work done for me, but if ever I should, it is my desire to pay them for their labors. Father Whittaker has been working for me for the past week and Mother Whittaker furnished us with a number of articles

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necessary in housekeeping which we were entirely destitute of, such as pots and kettles. May the Lord reward them for their goodness. I will in return for their kindness to me endeavor, by the help of Jehovah, to prove myself worthy of their good deeds and live a life which may be acceptable to God and show myself to be an honorable member of His Kingdom and a dutiful son-in-law. In the evening in my usual evening's devotion, I thanked the Lord for the comfortable house that he had given me and my wife and asked His blessings to rest upon it and dedicated it to the Lord. It is an adobe house with 15 inch walls, 15 feet by 16 feet--10 feet high and well-finished inside. It fronts the south Lot 5 corner lot, Block 19 (Plat A), and is the first adobie house built in Cedar City. Praise be the Lord for his goodness unto me forever. Amen

1. Henry Lunt, "Henry Lunt Journal," (Provo, Utah: B.Y.U. Library, copied from original journal, 1955), p. 114.
2. *Ibid.*, p. 116.
3. *Ibid.*, p. 121.
4. William E. Berrett, *The Restored Church*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret Book Company, 1969), p 297.
5. *Ibid.*, p. 297.
6. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 129.
7. Joel Johnson, *Deseret News*, Letter dated January 25, 1853, Elk Horn Springs (Enoch), Utah.